

100 Days of Linux - Day 085

Title: Creating and Using Aliases

Today's Goal

Learn how to create aliases to shorten frequently used Linux commands.

Why This Matters

Aliases improve productivity by replacing long commands with short, memorable names. They are widely used by developers, system administrators and DevOps engineers.

Commands of the Day

Syntax:

```
alias ll='ls -l'
alias la='ls -la'
alias cls='clear'
alias
unalias ll
```

Beginner Lesson

An alias is a shortcut for another command. Instead of typing a long command every time, create a short name. Use **alias** to create or view aliases and **unalias** to remove one.

Practice Questions

1. Create an alias named ll for ls -l.
2. Create an alias named cls for clear.
3. Display all current aliases.
4. Use the ll alias to list files.
5. Remove the ll alias using unalias.

Hints

Remember to use quotes around the command when creating an alias.

Mini Challenge

Create aliases named home, docs and work that simplify commands you use often, then test each one.

Common Mistakes

Forgetting quotes, expecting aliases to remain after opening a new terminal, or using spaces around '='.

Did You Know?

Many developers store their favourite aliases in `~/.bashrc` so they are available in every terminal session.

Pro Tip

Keep alias names short but meaningful, and avoid overriding common commands unless necessary.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

```
Q1: alias ll='ls -l'
Q2: alias cls='clear'
Q3: alias
Q4: ll
Q5: unalias ll
```

Homework

Create five useful aliases and save them to your `~/.bashrc` file, then reload it with **source ~/.bashrc**.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll revise environment variables and aliases with a hands-on quiz.